



WSQ
COURSE

COURSE SLIDES · WSQ

Customer-Centric Branding and Communication Tactics

WSQ Course Code: TGS-2026061321

Conducted by Tertiary Infotech Academy Pte Ltd · UEN 201200696W

Version v2 · 7 August 2026

© 2026 Tertiary Infotech Academy Pte Ltd. All rights reserved. · www.tertiarycourses.com.sg



COURSE ADMINISTRATION

Welcome & Housekeeping

Digital Attendance (Mandatory)

- It is mandatory to take the AM, PM and Assessment digital attendance for WSQ-funded courses.
- The trainer/administrator displays the digital attendance QR code from the SSG portal.
- Scan the QR code with your mobile phone camera and submit your attendance.
- A minimum of 75% attendance is required to be eligible for assessment and funding.

About the Trainer



Your Trainer

General Trainer template —
to be completed by the trainer

NAME

TITLE / DESIGNATION

QUALIFICATIONS

AREAS OF EXPERTISE

TRAINING & INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

CONTACT

About the Trainer



Dr. Alfred Ang

Principal Trainer
Tertiary Infotech Academy Pte. Ltd.

ROLE

Principal Trainer, Tertiary Infotech Academy Pte. Ltd.

CERTIFICATION / CREDENTIALS

20+ years of training and industry experience.

DELIVERS

WSQ courses on customer-centric branding, marketing communications and business skills.

FOUNDER

Founder and lead instructor at Tertiary Infotech / Tertiary Courses.

Let's Know Each Other

- Your name and organisation / role.
- Your experience with branding, marketing or communications (if any).
- A brand you personally admire — and why it works on you.

Ground Rules

1

Set your mobile phone to silent mode.

2

Actively participate — no question is too small.

3

Respect each other's views: agree to disagree.

4

One conversation at a time.

5

Be punctual; return from breaks on time.

6

75% attendance is required for funding eligibility.

Skills Framework

1

TSC Title

Brand Management

2

TSC Code

ICT-SNM-3002-1.1

3

Proficiency Level

Level 3

4

Structure

4 Learning Units (LU1–LU4), each mapped to a Learning Outcome.

Course Outline

1

LU1 — Stakeholders and Organisation

Internal & External Stakeholders · Audience Types · Brand Design · Reputation Assessment

2

LU2 — Customer Influence

Customer Perceptions · Brand Reputation · Campaign Reception · Active Listening

3

LU3 — Branding in Marketing

Branding Basics · Role in Marketing · Awareness Campaigns · PR Execution

4

LU4 — Branding Effectiveness

Reputation Metrics · Success Indicators · PR Tactics · KPI Monitoring · Continuous Improvement

SCHEDULE

Lesson Plan — 2 Days

Day 1

- Day 1 — Stakeholders, Customer Influence & Branding in Marketing (starts)
 - LU1: Stakeholders and Organisation (Activities 1–4)
 - LU2: Customer Influence (Activities 5–8)
 - LU3: Branding in Marketing — begins (Activities 9–12)

Day 2 & Assessment

- Day 2 — Branding in Marketing (cont'd), Branding Effectiveness & Assessment
 - LU3: Branding in Marketing — continued
 - LU4: Branding Effectiveness (Activities 13–17)
 - Assessment: WA (1h) + Case Study (1h), 4:00–6:00pm
- Daily timing
 - Day 1: 9:30am–6:30pm, 1-hour lunch. Day 2: 9:30am–6:00pm, 45-min lunch (to fit the assessment).

Learning Outcomes

1

Stakeholders & Organisation

Identify stakeholders/audiences and draft branding designs & reputation assessments.

2

Customer Influence

Capture and analyse customer insight through active listening.

3

Branding in Marketing

Execute branding campaigns, events and PR activities that build awareness.

4

Branding Effectiveness

Evaluate reputation and PR performance against KPIs and recommend improvements.

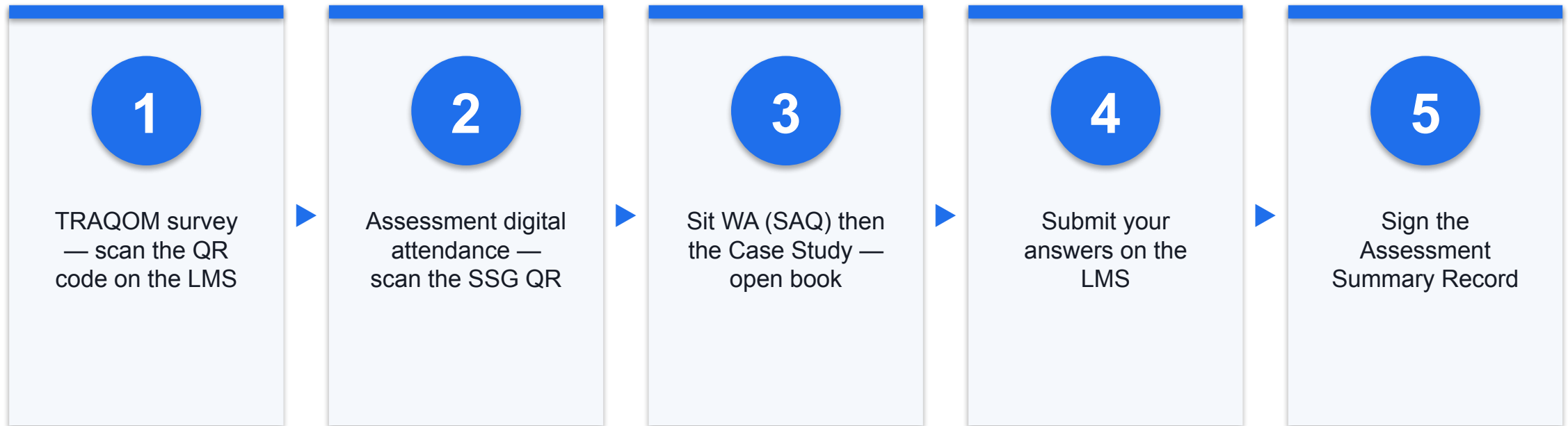
Briefing for Assessment

- Place phones and other materials under the table or on the floor.
- No photos or recording of assessment scripts.
- No discussion during the assessment.
- Use a black/blue pen for hard-copy assessments.
- No liquid paper / correction tape.
- Scripts are collected when time is up.

Assessment

- Written Assessment (WA) — Short-Answer Questions (SAQ), 1 hour, open book.
- Case Study (CS) — one continuous branding scenario with open-ended tasks, 1 hour, open book.
- Format: Open Book — slides, Learner Guide and approved materials only.
- A minimum of 75% attendance (per SSG Digital Attendance record) is required to be eligible for assessment and funding. Learners must be assessed as Competent and complete the TRAQOM survey.
- An appeal process is available if required.

Assessment Flow



Courseware & Assessment on the LMS

Everything for the open-book assessment — slides, Learner Guide and submissions — lives on the LMS.



Tertiary Infotech Academy

LMS and TMS for SSG courses

Sign in / OTP

lms-tms.tertiaryinfotech.com

1

Sign in

Log in with your registered email (OTP or password).

2

Download materials

Slides and the Learner Guide from the course page — your open-book references.

3

Submit answers

Upload your Written Assessment and Case Study answers on the LMS.

4

TRAQOM survey

Complete the TRAQOM survey via the QR code shown on the LMS.

<https://lms-tms.tertiaryinfotech.com/>

LU1

Stakeholders and Organisation

Internal & External Stakeholders · Audience Types · Brand Design · Reputation Assessment

Key Concepts — Stakeholders and Organisation

1

Internal stakeholders (management, employees) and external stakeholders (customers, partners, investors, media) each hold a different level of influence over — and interest in — the brand.

2

External audiences segment into customers, partners, investors and media; each needs its own communication approach and message.

3

Branding designs and ideas should foreground the product or service's attributes and the concrete benefits they deliver to the audience.

4

Assessing an organisation's reputation on social media and other platforms — reviews, mentions, sentiment — is the starting point for every branding decision.

The Modern Brand Ecosystem

Four forces now shape how customers trust and choose brands.

The Shift — Philosophy

Moving from product-centric innovation to a customer-back business model (CBM) to drive sustainable growth.

The Mechanics — System

Abandoning the linear funnel for a non-linear, infinitely looping customer journey.

The Core — Emotion

Engineering authenticity and shared values as the primary engines of brand loyalty and trust.

The Scale — AI

Governing the new frontier where agentic AI acts autonomously on behalf of the brand.

The Strategic Paradigm Shift

Customer-centric organisations think, innovate and measure differently.

	Product-Centric	Customer-Centric
Core philosophy	“If we build it, they will come”	“Obsession with customer pain points and delight”
Innovation style	High-risk, creates new markets, heavy R&D	Incremental, read-and-react, user research-driven
Risk profile	High tolerance for failure and pivots	Lower risk, focused on continuous feedback loops
Success metric	One-time, big-ticket sales	Lifetime value, reduced churn, Net Promoter Scores

The Economics of Customer Obsession

Firms implementing a customer-experience (CX) approach routinely outperform product-led peers.

+49%

Faster profit growth

+41%

Higher revenue expansion

+51%

Stronger customer retention

73% of customers now expect companies to treat them as individuals, not numbers — up from just 39% in 2023.

In-Class Activities — Stakeholders and Organisation

Activities 1–2

- Stakeholder Influence Mapping
- Audience Mapping Workshop

Activities 3–4

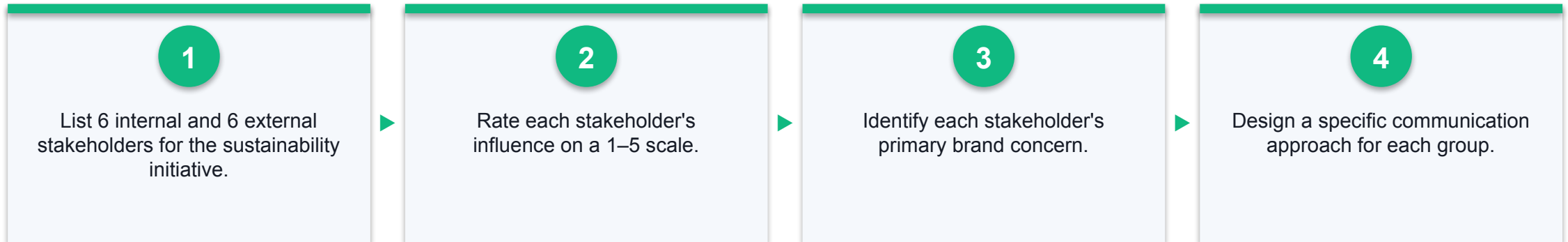
- Brand Attribute Mapping
- Digital Reputation Audit Exercise

Stakeholder Influence Mapping

ACTIVITY 1

Your company is launching a new sustainability initiative. Map internal and external stakeholders, assess their influence levels, and design engagement strategies for each group.

WORKFLOW



YOU'LL PRODUCE

A stakeholder influence matrix (12 stakeholders) with an engagement strategy for each group

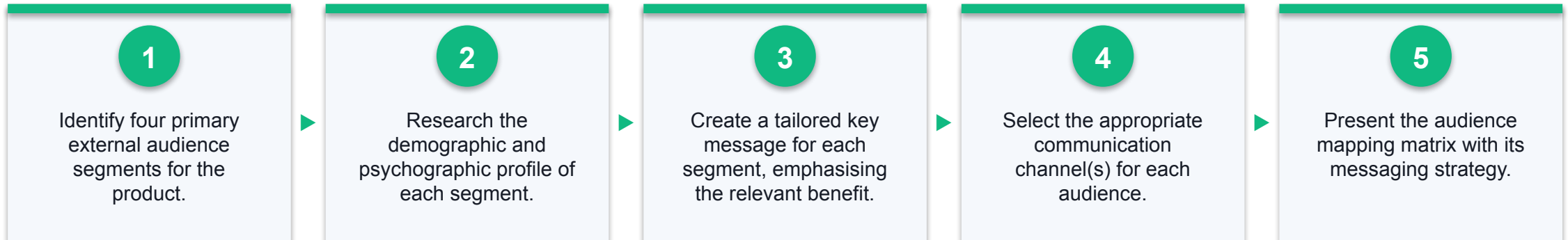
Duration
25 minutes

Audience Mapping Workshop

ACTIVITY 2

Your company is launching a new sustainability product line. Map external audiences and develop targeted messaging strategies for each segment.

WORKFLOW



YOU'LL PRODUCE

An audience mapping matrix covering 4 external segments with tailored messaging and channels

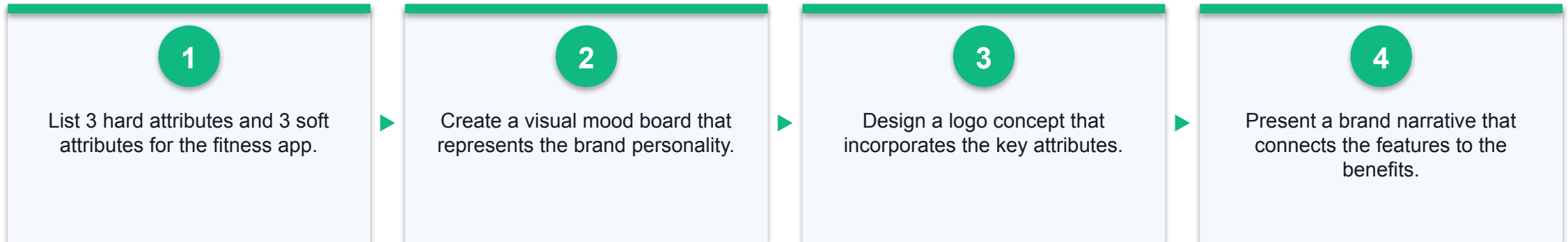
Duration
25 minutes

Brand Attribute Mapping

ACTIVITY 3

Design a brand identity for a new fitness app targeting busy professionals, mapping both hard attributes (features) and soft attributes (lifestyle benefits) into a compelling visual concept.

WORKFLOW



YOU'LL PRODUCE

A brand attribute map (3 hard + 3 soft attributes), a mood board and a logo concept

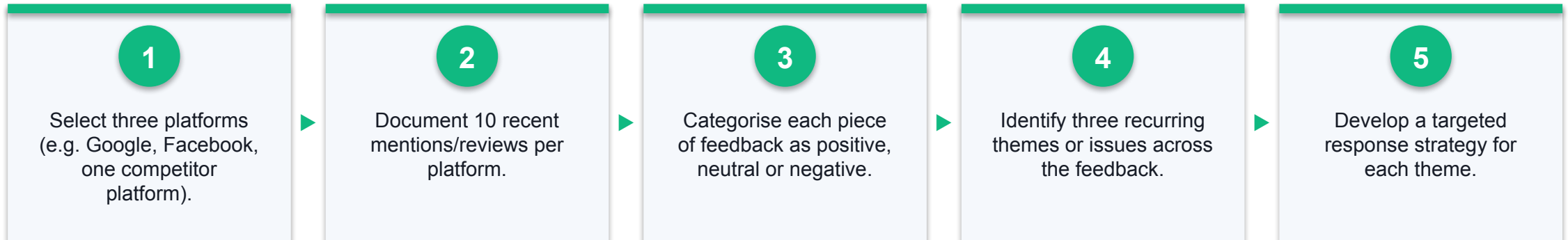
Duration
30 minutes

Digital Reputation Audit Exercise

ACTIVITY 4

Your organisation has received mixed customer feedback across social platforms. Conduct a reputation assessment to identify improvement opportunities and develop an action plan.

WORKFLOW



YOU'LL PRODUCE

A reputation-assessment report covering 3 platforms with sentiment breakdown and an action plan

Duration
45 minutes

Recap — Stakeholders and Organisation

1

Stakeholder Influence Mapping

You can now: Identify internal and external stakeholders influencing the brand.

2

Audience Mapping Workshop

You can now: Recognise the types of external audience and their needs.

3

Brand Attribute Mapping

You can now: Draft branding designs and ideas highlighting the product or service's attributes and benefits.

4

Digital Reputation Audit Exercise

You can now: Assess the organisation's reputation on social media and other platforms.

LU2

Customer Influence

Customer Perceptions · Brand Reputation · Campaign Reception · Active Listening

Key Concepts — Customer Influence

1

Customers form perceptions of a brand, its products and its services from quality, experience and communication — a gap often exists between what a company believes and what customers actually feel.

2

Customers actively shape brand reputation through word-of-mouth, reviews and advocacy — their voice can amplify or damage a brand faster than any paid campaign.

3

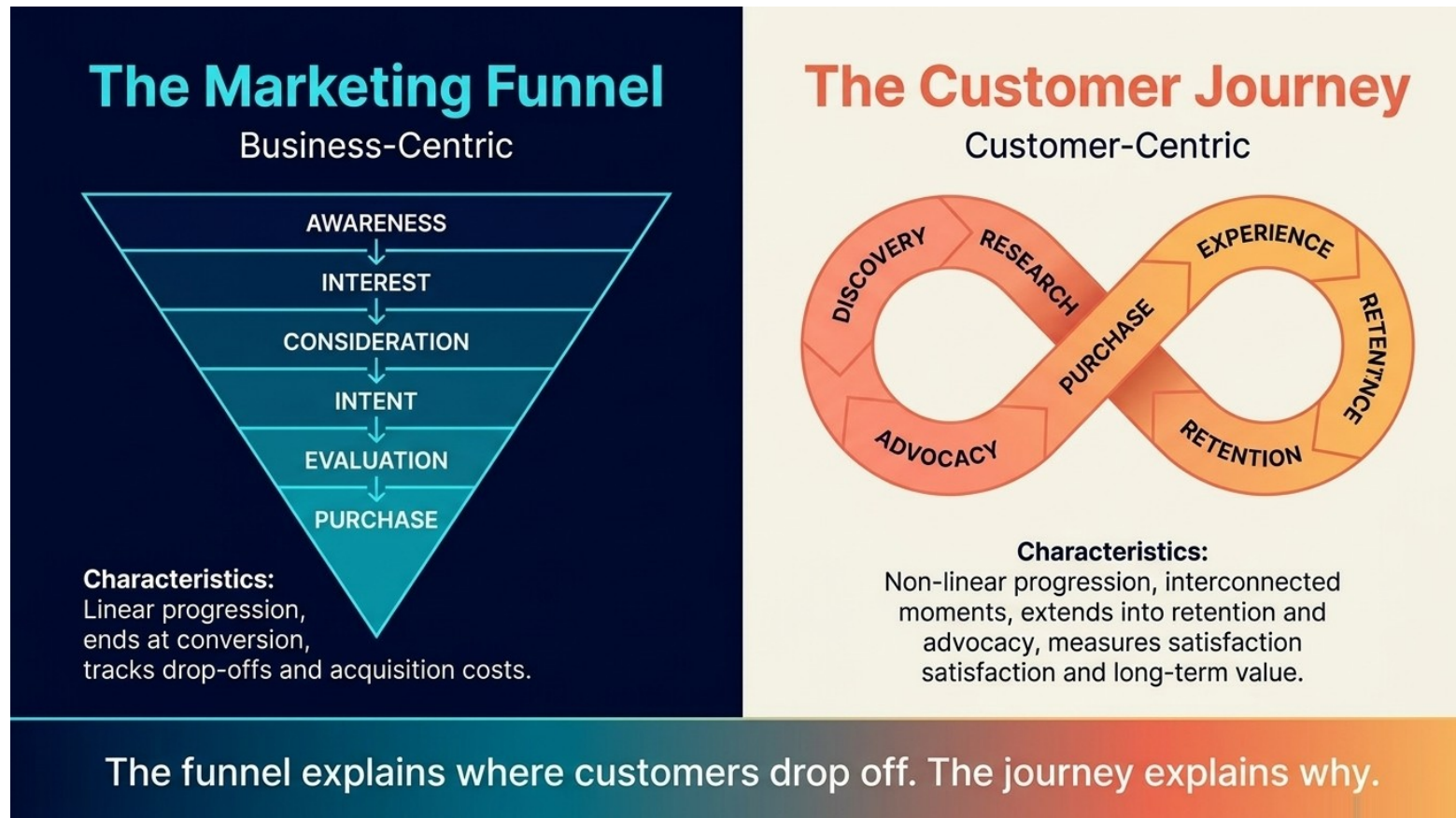
Documenting customer reception and the outcome of branding campaigns turns anecdotal feedback into evidence for future campaign decisions.

4

Active listening — full attention, a structured framework, and paraphrasing without judgement — reveals the customer's true perspective of the organisation.

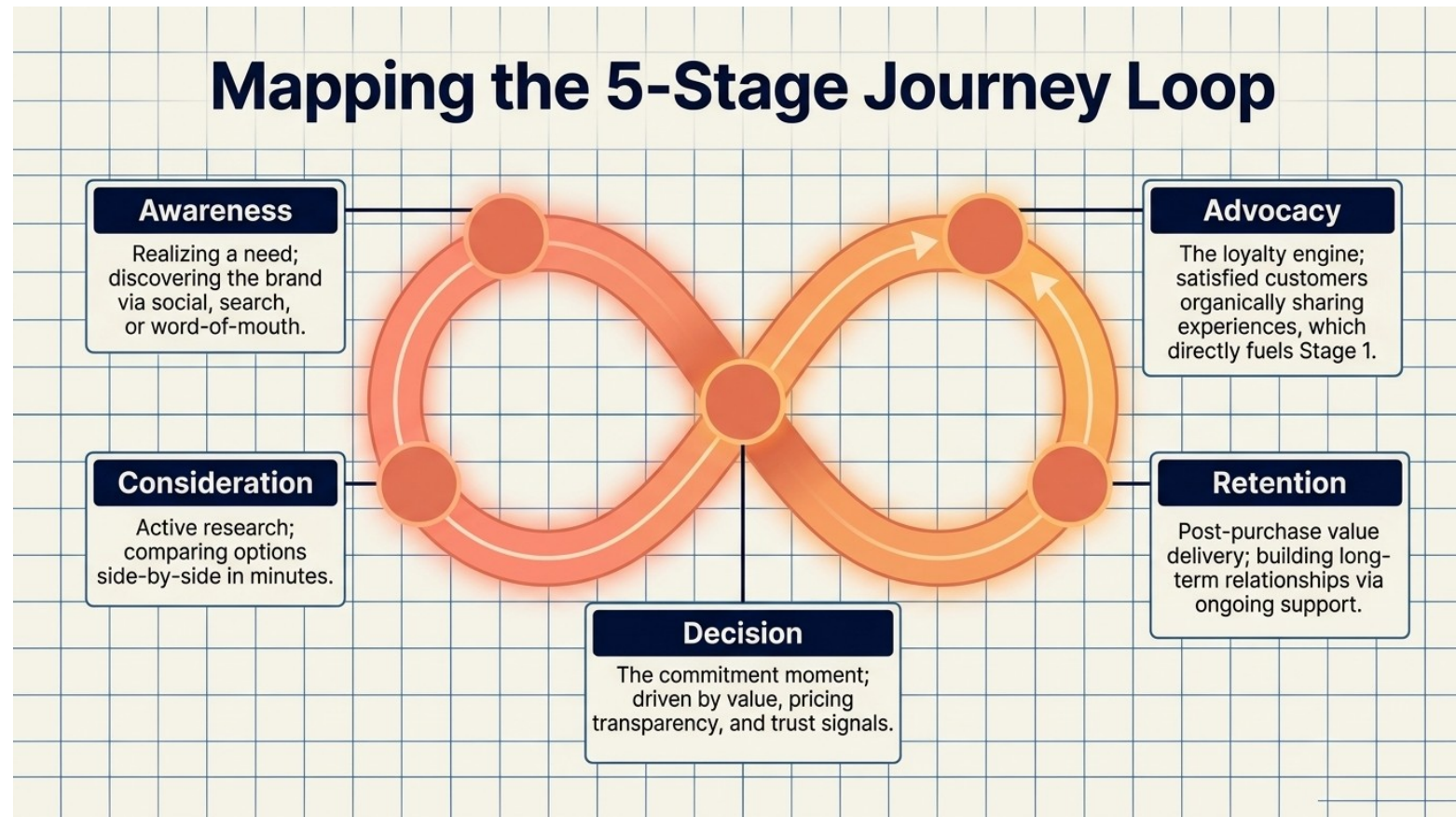
The Marketing Funnel vs the Customer Journey

The funnel explains where customers drop off; the journey explains why.



Mapping the 5-Stage Journey Loop

Awareness → Consideration → Decision → Retention → Advocacy — and advocacy feeds awareness again.



The Engine of Loyalty: Emotional Branding

Affect-driven purchasing decisions outpace purely rational choices.

45.2%

say an emotional connection
with a brand is very important

42%

associate their favourite brands
with trust & reliability

88.1%

actively choose branded
products over non-branded
alternatives

55% of loyalty is driven by quality — but 32% is driven entirely by customer service and emotional support.

In-Class Activities — Customer Influence

Activities 5–6

- Brand Perception Audit
- Brand Advocacy Assessment

Activities 7–8

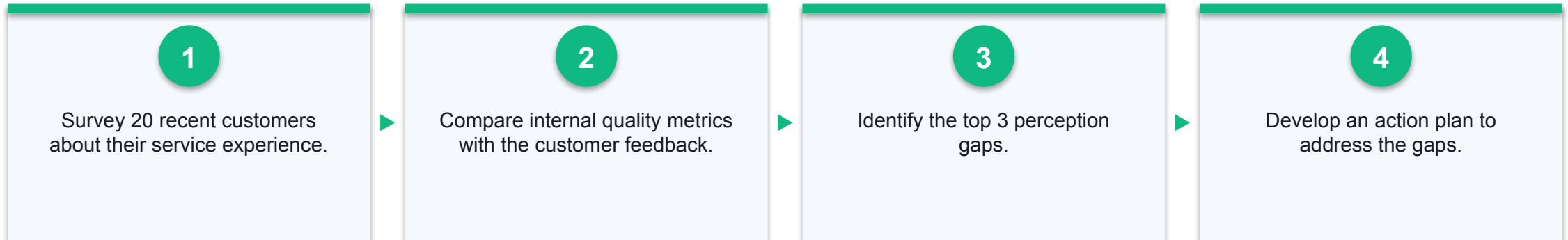
- Campaign Documentation Audit
- Customer Perspective Analysis

Brand Perception Audit

ACTIVITY 5

Your company recently received mixed customer reviews. Management believes service quality is excellent, but customer-satisfaction scores are declining. Conduct a perception audit to identify the gaps.

WORKFLOW



YOU'LL PRODUCE

A perception-gap analysis report comparing internal quality metrics with customer feedback

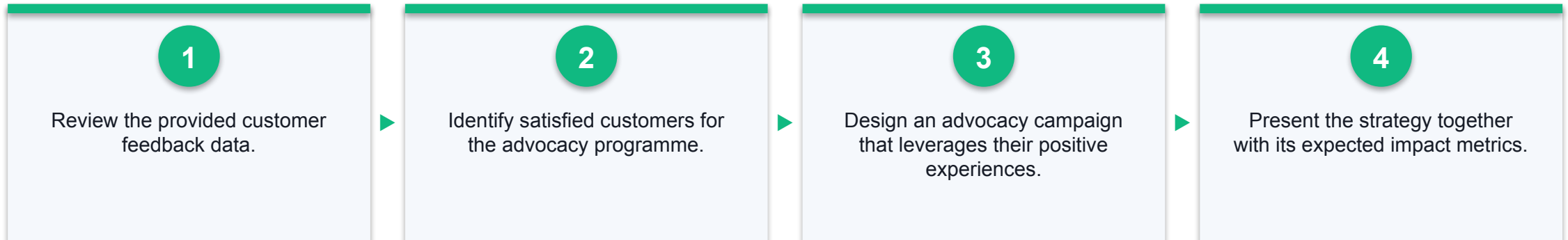
Duration
25 minutes

Brand Advocacy Assessment

ACTIVITY 6

Your company recently received mixed reviews online. As brand manager, analyse customer feedback and develop an advocacy strategy to improve brand reputation through existing satisfied customers.

WORKFLOW



YOU'LL PRODUCE

A customer-advocacy strategy document with target impact metrics

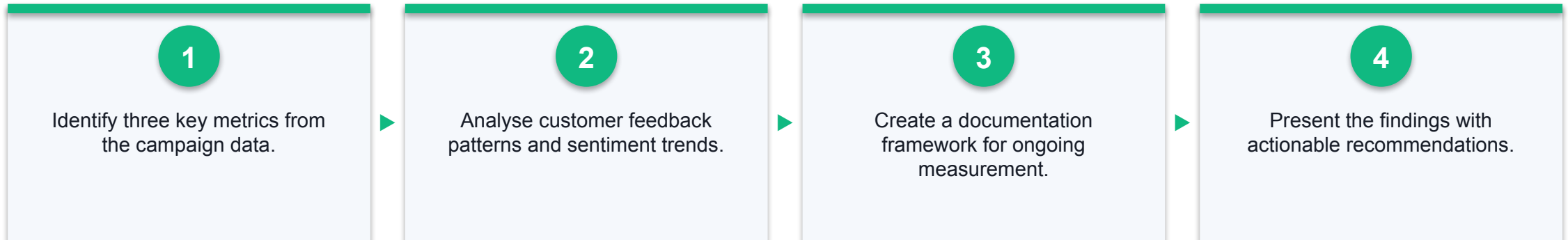
Duration
25 minutes

Campaign Documentation Audit

ACTIVITY 7

Your company launched a new product branding campaign three months ago. Management needs a documentation report on customer reception and campaign outcomes to inform future marketing investment.

WORKFLOW



YOU'LL PRODUCE

A structured campaign-reception report with metrics, analysis and optimisation recommendations

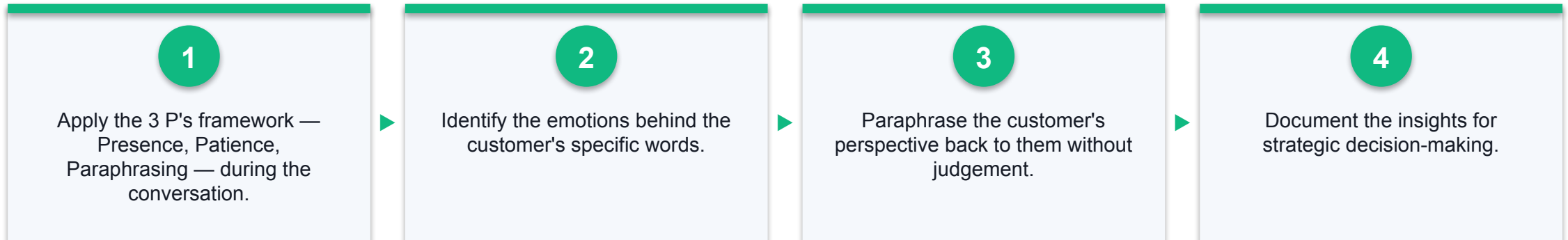
Duration
25 minutes

Customer Perspective Analysis

ACTIVITY 8

You receive a complaint from a long-term customer expressing frustration about recent service changes. They say they feel 'unheard' and 'unimportant' to your organisation.

WORKFLOW



YOU'LL PRODUCE

A completed customer-perspective analysis report with actionable insights

Duration
25 minutes

Recap — Customer Influence

1

Brand Perception Audit

You can now: Assess customer perceptions of the brand, products and services.

2

Brand Advocacy Assessment

You can now: Recognise the importance of the customer in influencing brand reputation.

3

Campaign Documentation Audit

You can now: Document customer reception to the brand and the outcome of branding campaigns.

4

Customer Perspective Analysis

You can now: Perform active listening from the customer to understand the customer's perspective of the organisation.

LU3

Branding in Marketing

Branding Basics · Role in Marketing · Awareness Campaigns · PR Execution

Key Concepts — Branding in Marketing

1

Branding basics — visual identity, brand values, brand voice and brand guidelines — give a business a consistent, recognisable presence.

2

Branding plays a central role in marketing: it builds trust, differentiates from competitors and creates the emotional connection that drives loyalty.

3

Executing branding campaigns, events and activities — from social pushes to experiential pop-ups — raises brand awareness across the target audience.

4

Public-relations campaigns must align to the brand positioning strategy, the operational plan and the marketing budget to stay credible and sustainable.

The Anatomy of Brand Authenticity

Authenticity is engineered through four repeatable practices.

Radical Transparency

Open communication about business practices and product origins — e.g. Patagonia's Footprint Chronicles detailing supply-chain realities.

Value Alignment

Emotional connection forged through shared beliefs and societal commitment — e.g. Ben & Jerry's integration of social justice into core operations.

Authentic Storytelling

Humanising the brand through relatable, non-fabricated narratives — e.g. Nike highlighting genuine struggles and triumphs of real athletes.

Quality Assurance

Trust earned through unwavering consistency and reliability — e.g. Toyota's rigorous quality control building global dependability.

The Trust Fracture: the Say-Do Gap

How trust fractures

- Brand authenticity is destroyed by inauthentic practices — when a company's actions contradict its stated promises.
- Discrepancies between marketing claims and operational reality create a trust fracture that severs the customer journey loop permanently.
- PR campaigns can only amplify what operations can prove.

Case: the Volkswagen emissions scandal

- Software was installed to cheat emissions tests.
- The deception directly contradicted public claims of environmental responsibility.
- Result: immediate, catastrophic loss of consumer trust — a say-do gap no campaign could repair.

In-Class Activities — Branding in Marketing

Activities 9–10

- Brand Audit Workshop
- Brand-Marketing Audit Exercise

Activities 11–12

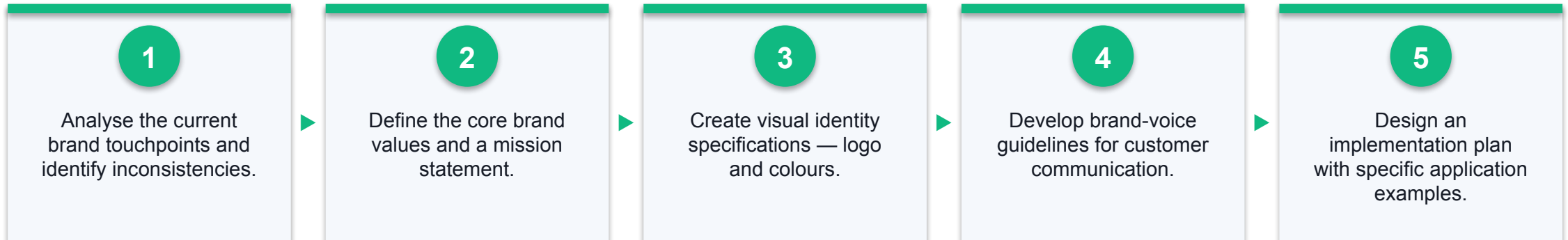
- Brand Activation Planning Workshop
- PR Campaign Budget Planning

Brand Audit Workshop

ACTIVITY 9

You are consulting for a local restaurant with inconsistent branding across their website, social media, and physical location. The owner wants to understand how to create unified brand guidelines.

WORKFLOW



YOU'LL PRODUCE

A brand-guidelines document — visual standards, voice guidelines and an implementation roadmap

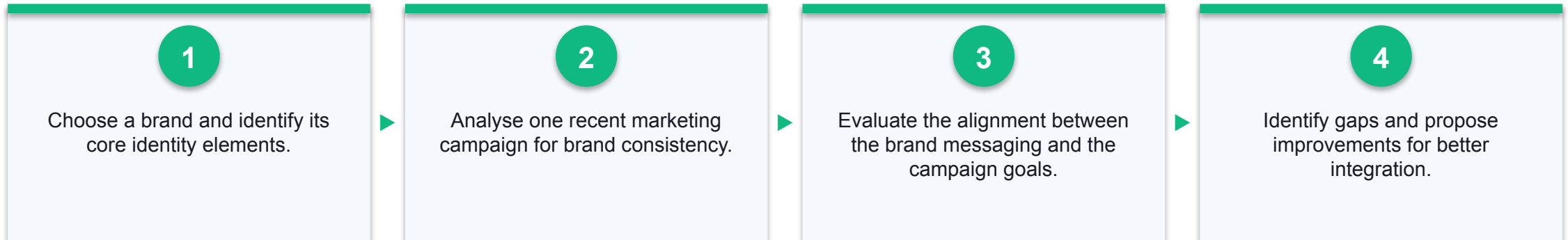
Duration
30 minutes

Brand-Marketing Audit Exercise

ACTIVITY 10

You are a marketing manager evaluating how well your company's current marketing campaigns align with brand identity. Select a real company and analyse one of their recent marketing campaigns.

WORKFLOW



YOU'LL PRODUCE

A brand-audit report with a consistency assessment and recommendations

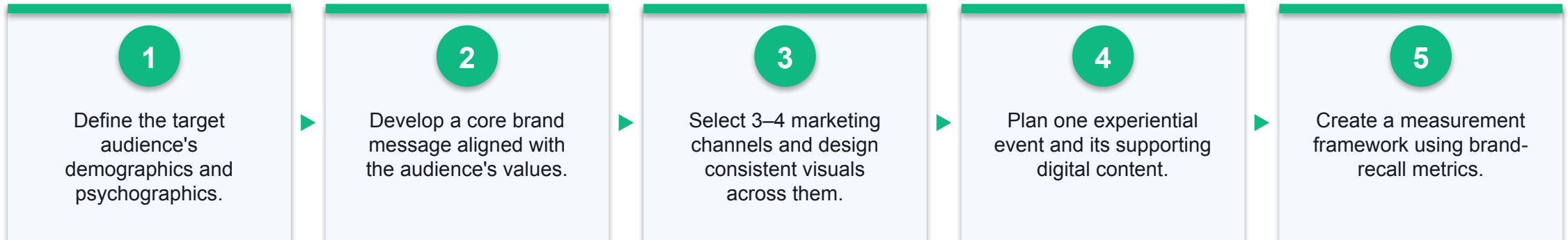
Duration
20 minutes

Brand Activation Planning Workshop

ACTIVITY 11

Your organisation wants to launch a new product line and needs to increase brand awareness by 40% within 6 months. Design a multi-channel campaign that includes both digital and experiential elements.

WORKFLOW



YOU'LL PRODUCE

A campaign-strategy document with timeline, budget allocation and success metrics

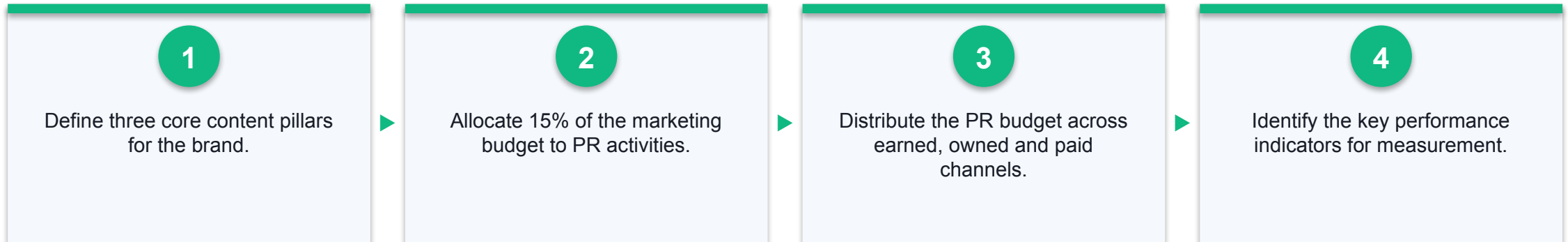
Duration
30 minutes

PR Campaign Budget Planning

ACTIVITY 12

You're the marketing manager for a growth-stage tech company launching a new product. Create a PR campaign budget aligned with the brand positioning strategy.

WORKFLOW



YOU'LL PRODUCE

A PR budget proposal with channel allocation and success metrics

Duration
25 minutes

Recap — Branding in Marketing

1

Brand Audit Workshop

You can now: Explain the basics of branding.

2

Brand-Marketing Audit Exercise

You can now: Explain the role of branding in marketing.

3

Brand Activation Planning Workshop

You can now: Execute branding campaigns, events and activities to increase brand awareness.

4

PR Campaign Budget Planning

You can now: Execute public-relations campaigns in alignment to brand positioning strategies, operational plans and budget.

LU4

Branding Effectiveness

Reputation Metrics · Success Indicators · PR Tactics · KPI Monitoring · Continuous Improvement

Key Concepts — Branding Effectiveness

1

Reputation is measured through social metrics, digital metrics (traffic, mentions) and business KPIs (NPS, satisfaction) across every platform the organisation touches.

2

Successful branding shows up in awareness, customer loyalty, financial impact and trust metrics — tracked consistently over time, not measured once.

3

Public-relations tactics — media relations, community outreach, crisis management and digital engagement — extend the brand's message beyond paid channels.

4

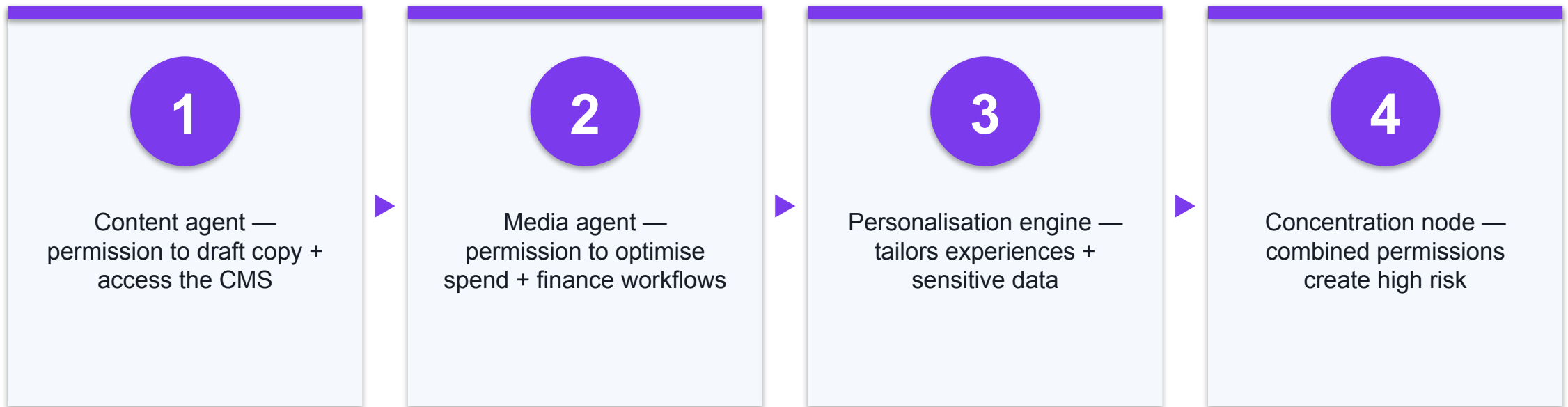
Monitoring the brand against SMART KPIs and acting on the gaps turns brand management into a continuous-improvement cycle rather than a one-off campaign.

LU4 · THE NEXT FRONTIER: AGENTIC AI

“The agent is becoming the brand.”

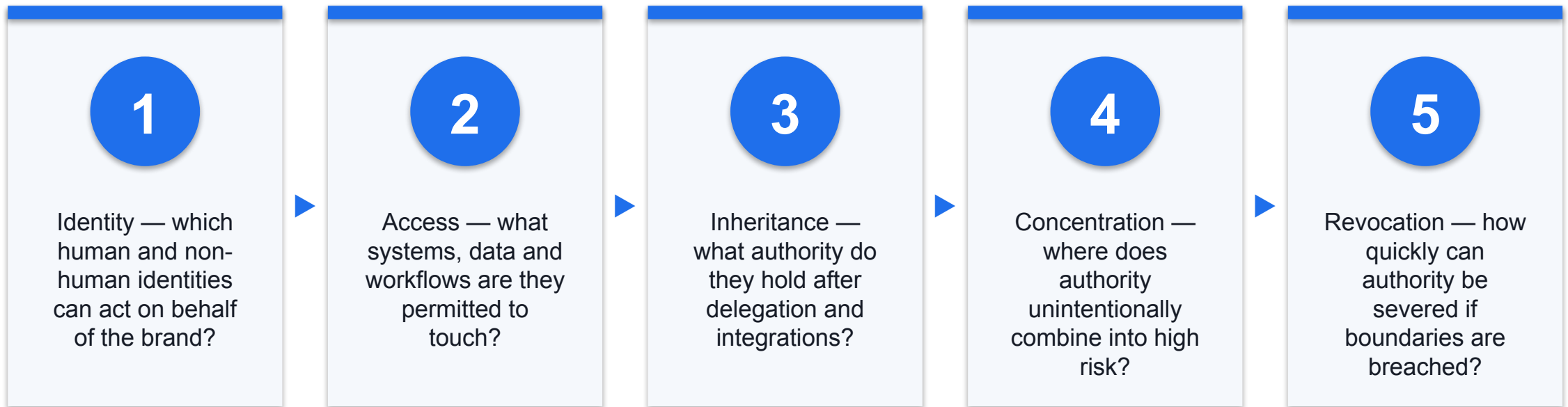
Nine in ten US marketing agencies now use generative AI, and half use agentic AI for execution. AI is no longer just generating content — it is deciding, spending, personalising and interacting directly with customers.

The Risk Vector: Authority Concentration



In an agentic enterprise, risk moves through authority pathways, not people. Human approvals cannot scale at machine speed to monitor these intersections.

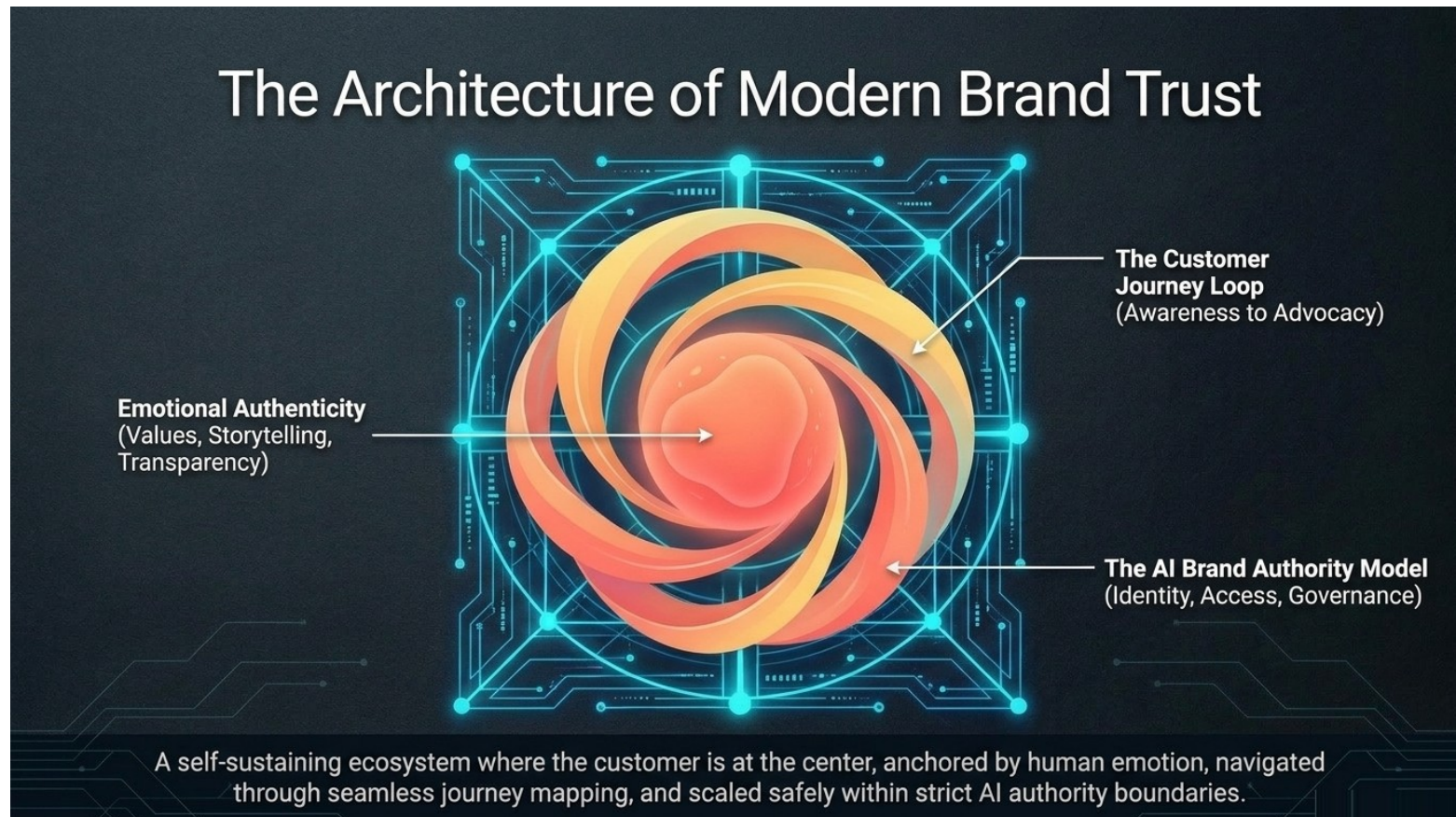
The Brand Authority Model



Enterprise Authority Assurance replaces the editorial calendar.

The Architecture of Modern Brand Trust

The customer at the centre — anchored by emotion, navigated through journey mapping, scaled safely within strict AI authority boundaries.



The Executive Playbook

01

Shift the Metric

Move away from pure acquisition costs. Restructure KPIs around lifetime value, Net Promoter Scores and journey retention.

02

Map the Reality, Not the Theory

Audit the 5-stage customer journey loop using actual behavioural data, not internal corporate assumptions. Find the friction.

03

Close the Say-Do Gap

Audit your brand's authenticity. Ensure marketing claims — environmental, social, quality — are rigidly matched by operational reality.

04

Build the Authority Model

Stop relying on human bottlenecks for AI approval. Map identity, access and authority concentration for every agentic system touching your brand.

Trust cannot be retrofitted. It must be engineered.

In-Class Activities — Branding Effectiveness

Activities 13–14

- Platform Reputation Audit
- Brand Health Assessment

Activities 15–16

- PR Crisis Response Plan
- KPI Dashboard Design

Activities 17–17

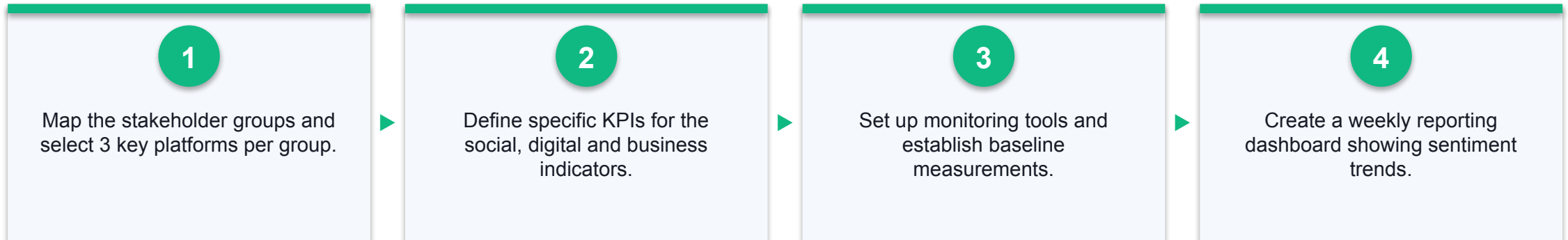
- PR Campaign Audit Exercise

Platform Reputation Audit

ACTIVITY 13

Your organisation needs to establish reputation monitoring for a new product launch across social media, review sites, and business platforms.

WORKFLOW



YOU'LL PRODUCE

A reputation-monitoring framework with defined metrics and tracking systems

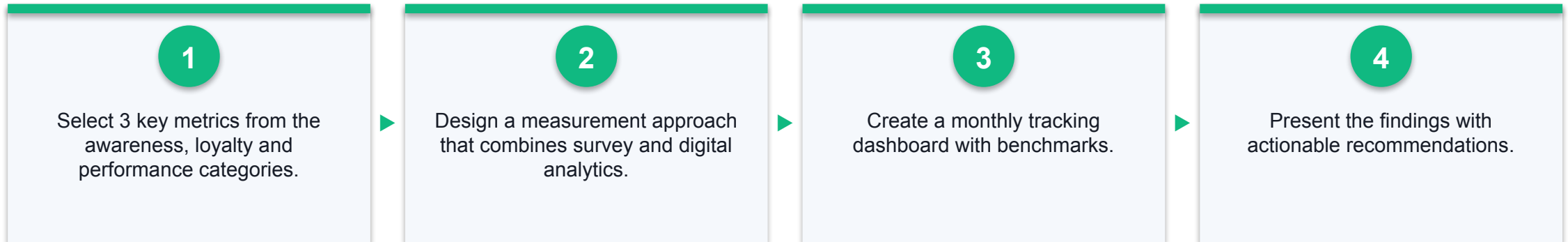
Duration
20 minutes

Brand Health Assessment

ACTIVITY 14

You are a marketing manager evaluating your company's brand performance using both traditional and digital metrics.

WORKFLOW



YOU'LL PRODUCE

A brand-health scorecard with metric definitions, current performance and an improvement plan

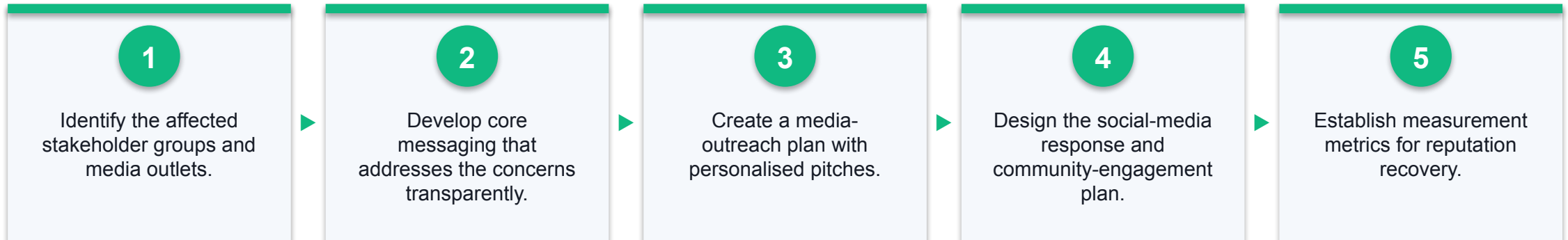
Duration
25 minutes

PR Crisis Response Plan

ACTIVITY 15

Your company faces negative social-media coverage about product-quality issues. Design a comprehensive PR response strategy using the tactics learned.

WORKFLOW



YOU'LL PRODUCE

A crisis-communication plan with timelines and responsible parties

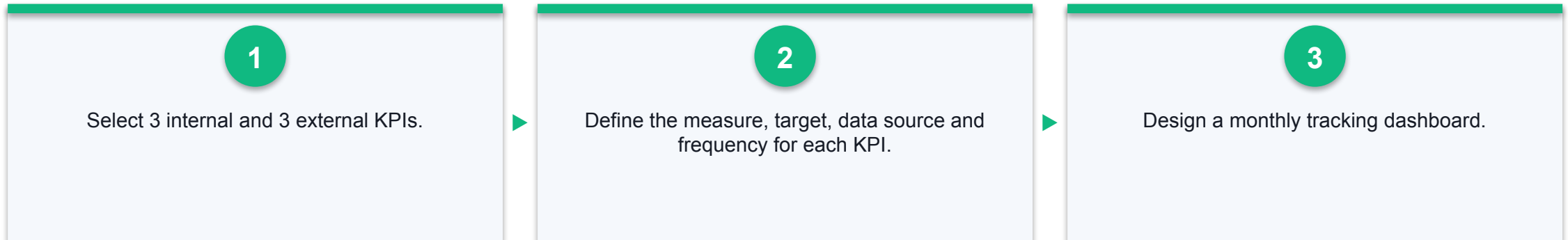
Duration
25 minutes

KPI Dashboard Design

ACTIVITY 16

Create a brand KPI monitoring framework for a retail company launching new product lines.

WORKFLOW



YOU'LL PRODUCE

A complete KPI framework with a tracking schedule

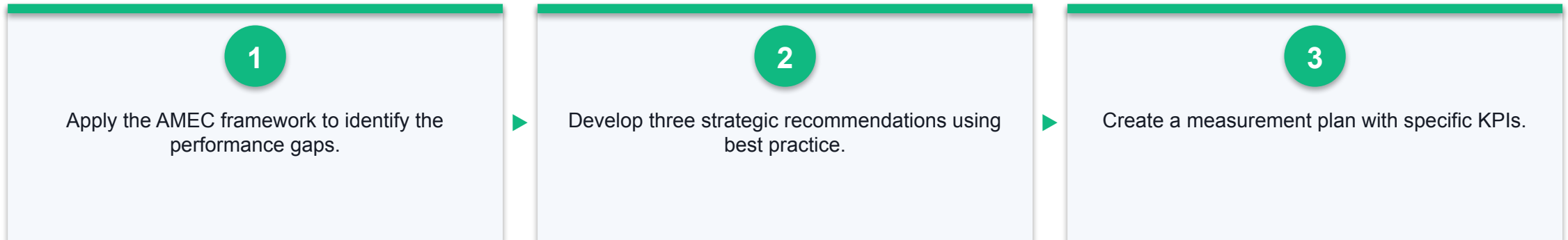
Duration
20 minutes

PR Campaign Audit Exercise

ACTIVITY 17

Your organisation's recent product-launch campaign achieved 500K impressions but only 15% top-tier coverage and 45% message penetration. Stakeholders are questioning the campaign's business impact.

WORKFLOW



YOU'LL PRODUCE

An improvement proposal with metrics, built using the AMEC measurement framework

Duration
25 minutes

Recap — Branding Effectiveness

1

Platform Reputation Audit

You can now: Identify measures or indicators of the organisation's reputation on different platforms.

2

Brand Health Assessment

You can now: Recognise the indicators of successful branding.

3

PR Crisis Response Plan

You can now: Apply public-relations tactics.

4

KPI Dashboard Design

You can now: Monitor the success of the brand against Key Performance Indicators (KPI).

5

PR Campaign Audit Exercise

You can now: Provide suggestions to improve public-relations campaign effectiveness.



WRAP-UP

Course Summary & Next Steps

What You Achieved

1

Stakeholders & Organisation

Mapped stakeholders and audiences; drafted brand designs and reputation assessments.

2

Customer Influence

Captured and documented customer perception through active listening.

3

Branding in Marketing

Executed branding and PR campaigns aligned to strategy, plan and budget.

4

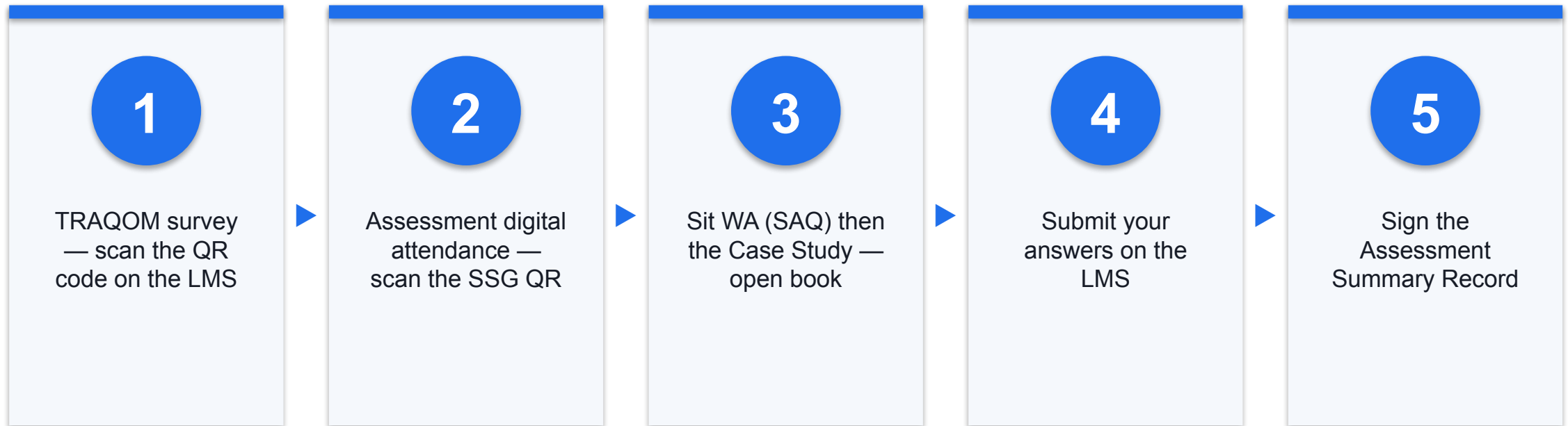
Branding Effectiveness

Measured reputation and PR performance against KPIs and proposed improvements.

Assessment

- Written Assessment (WA, SAQ) — 1 hour. Case Study (CS) — 1 hour.
- Open book: slides, Learner Guide and approved materials only.
- Remember to complete the TRAQOM survey and take the Assessment digital attendance (two separate steps).
- Submit your completed answers on the LMS at <https://lms-tms.tertiaryinfotech.com/>.

Assessment Flow



Digital Attendance (Mandatory)

- It is mandatory to take the AM, PM and Assessment digital attendance for WSQ-funded courses.
- The trainer/administrator displays the digital attendance QR code from the SSG portal.
- Scan the QR code with your mobile phone camera and submit your attendance.
- A minimum of 75% attendance is required to be eligible for assessment and funding.

SEE YOU AT THE NEXT ONE

Thank You!

You are now equipped to build customer-centric brand communication that earns trust and drives results.